

Document 11: Diabetes Mellitus - Overview

Diabetes mellitus is a group of metabolic disorders characterized by chronic hyperglycemia resulting from defects in insulin secretion, insulin action, or both. The main types are Type 1 (autoimmune destruction of insulin-producing cells), Type 2 (insulin resistance), and gestational diabetes (occurring during pregnancy). Symptoms include excessive thirst, frequent urination, unexplained weight loss, fatigue, and blurred vision. Long-term complications include cardiovascular disease, neuropathy, kidney failure, and retinopathy. Management involves lifestyle changes, blood glucose monitoring, oral hypoglycemic agents, and insulin therapy.